

Powering Viksit Bharat: CCL's Role in Building a Self-Reliant and Sustainable India

An Interview with Nilendu Kumar Singh, Chairman & Managing Director,
Central Coalfields Limited (CCL), Ranchi



■ Shri Nilendu Kumar Singh

Chairman-cum-Managing Director (CMD) Company: Central Coalfields Limited (CCL) (a subsidiary of Coal India Limited)

As India pursues the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, how do you see CCL's role in supporting the country's energy and economic growth?

Coal continues to play a critical role in India's energy security, even as the country rapidly expands renewable energy. Reliable coal supply remains essential for thermal power generation and for supporting industries, infrastructure, railways and households. CCL, a Miniratna company and subsidiary of Coal India Limited, therefore has a strategic responsibility to ensure dependable coal production and supply.

Operating across the coal-rich districts of Jharkhand, including Ranchi, Ramgarh, Hazaribagh, Chatra, Bokaro, Giridih, Latehar and Palamu, CCL is strengthening production capacity while modernising mining and evacuation infrastructure.

Our objective is not simply to produce more coal, but to make mining more efficient, technology-driven, environmentally responsible and socially inclusive.

How is CCL modernising its mining and coal evacuation operations?

Technology and operational efficiency are central to our approach. The Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC) at Ranchi enables real-time monitoring of operations across our projects. This improves transparency, logistics management and decision-making, while helping optimise coal evacuation and supply. We are also strengthening First Mile Connectivity (FMC), which enables mechanised transportation of coal from the mine pithead to railway sidings. This reduces dependence on road transportation and consequently helps

lower dust pollution, traffic congestion, fuel consumption and carbon emissions.

A 7.5 million tonnes per year coal handling plant is already operational in the Barka-Sayal area. Equipped with crushing, sizing, storage and rapid loading facilities, such systems are helping create a faster, cleaner and more efficient coal evacuation network.

Coal mining is often associated with environmental concerns. How is CCL addressing sustainability?

Sustainability is increasingly becoming integral to our mining philosophy. We are deploying environmentally conscious technologies such as surface miners, Xcentric rippers and continuous miners in suitable projects. These technologies reduce the requirement for blasting, thereby lowering dust, vibration and noise while improving operational safety.

We have also established Sustainable Development Cells to strengthen environmental monitoring, compliance, reclamation and scientific interventions. Our approach is based on the principle that responsible mining must minimise environmental impact throughout the mining lifecycle.

Reclamation and ecological restoration are equally important. CCL has planted more than 1.1 crore trees across approximately 5,720 hectares, with scientifically planned revegetation using indigenous species. We are also working with institutions such as the Institute of Forest Productivity for ecological studies and environmental monitoring, including in sensitive riverine ecosystems.

Can a coal-producing company also contribute to India's renewable energy transition?

Absolutely. India's energy transition requires a pragmatic and balanced approach. While coal will remain important for energy security in the